



Lena 17

The 17-year-old patient is an only child. Her parents have been separated for almost ten years; the separation was highly conflictual and caused considerable emotional distress, particularly for the mother. The mother struggled for a long time to process the separation. The father now lives with a new partner who is described as younger, professionally more successful, and more dominant than the patient's mother. The mother does not have a new partner. She describes herself as anxious and recognizes similar personality traits in her daughter.

The patient presents as highly intelligent, reflective, controlled, and extremely achievement-oriented. She attends the 10th grade of a secondary school (Gymnasium) and achieves excellent academic results. She consistently places her own needs behind academic demands and performance expectations. During therapy, she has increasingly been able to perceive her own needs more consciously. In line with Grawe's basic psychological needs, the therapeutic goal is particularly to restore a better balance regarding the need for pleasure and enjoyment, as her needs for safety, orientation, and control have so far been predominant. Overall, the patient appears very controlled and focused and allows herself little time for rest or recovery.

She reports that the obsessive-compulsive symptoms began during the COVID-19 pandemic. In addition, she experiences her father's new partner as very dominant and demanding and has difficulty expressing her own needs within this family system.

Diagnoses:

- Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder (OCD) – predominantly obsessive thoughts / ruminative obsessions
- Social Anxiety Disorder – provisional diagnosis (suspected)

Symptoms:

The patient describes intrusive obsessive thoughts when seeing knives. These thoughts involve fears that she could or might have to harm other people or pets, especially individuals close to her. These thoughts trigger intense anxiety and tension. Following a partial improvement in the obsessive-compulsive symptoms, increasing social insecurity and social anxiety developed.